

Empowering Future Filmmakers: A Hands-on Workshop Approach to Smartphone Photography, CapCut Video Editing and Videography for NCE Students in Federal College of Education, Zaria

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Abstract

This paper examines the pedagogical implementation and outcomes of a one-day film production appreciation workshop designed for Nigeria Certificate in Education (NCE) III students within the Department of Theatre Arts at the Federal University of Education, Zaria. While conventional creative arts curricula frequently default to theoretical delivery due to institutional resource scarcity, this study addresses an essential educational challenge by deploying a distinct rotational workshop model. Sixty participants were partitioned into sub-cohorts and rotated sequentially through three intensive 45-minute practical modules: smartphone photography, CapCut mobile video editing, and videography. Backed by the curricular provision for embedded experts, the intervention anchors itself in a theory-to-practice strategy intended to accelerate vocational digital literacy before graduation. Quantitative data and qualitative thematic analysis reveal an exceptional 98.3% overall participation rate, with 85% of students demonstrating a post-workshop intent to pursue specialized industry tracks—led prominently by a 91.5% demand surge for mobile video editing. Beyond validating a localized training event, this study offers a vital conceptual contribution to mobile filmmaking pedagogy and vocational teacher-education frameworks in sub-Saharan Africa. It theorizes how democratic, "mobile-first" tools can bypass traditional infrastructure deficits, transforming passive media consumers into active creative producers. Ultimately, the paper provides a scalable, empirically backed instructional architecture for creative arts educators navigating under-resourced institutional landscapes globally.

Keywords: Smartphone photography, CapCut video editing, Mobile videography, Film production pedagogy, Embedded experts, Rotational learning model.

Introduction

The global creative economy has experienced rapid transformation in recent years, with digital content creation emerging as a viable professional pathway for young people across Africa (Ogunleye, 2025; Okonkwo & Adebayo, 2024). In Nigeria particularly, the film industry—popularly known as Nollywood—has grown into a multi-billion-dollar sector that demands a steady pipeline of skilled practitioners (Ekwueme & Okafor, 2023). Despite this demand, formal training institutions often struggle to equip students with practical, job-ready skills in film production due to resource constraints, outdated curricula, and insufficient hands-on learning opportunities (Adepoju, 2024).

The Nigeria Certificate in Education (NCE) programme, which serves as a primary pathway for training teachers in Nigerian colleges of education, includes courses designed to expose students to foundational knowledge in various disciplines. The course Introduction to Film Production at the Federal College of Education, Zaria, is one such offering. While the syllabus provides a theoretical framework for understanding film production, it also encourages excursions and industrial attachments to film studios and in some cases allows experts to be invited to demonstrate specific aspects of the course to students (NCCE, 2020). This provision aligns with the broader literature on experiential learning, which emphasizes that students acquire deeper understanding and retain knowledge more effectively when they engage directly with practical tasks (Kolb & Kolb, 2018; Omodan & Dube, 2021).

This paper reports on a workshop intervention conducted as part of the Introduction to Film Production course. The workshop was designed to achieve three objectives:

- (a) To introduce students to the fundamental techniques of smartphone photography;
- (b) To provide hands-on training in video editing using the CapCut application; and
- (c) To develop basic videography skills for narrative construction.

The workshop was delivered over a single day, with students rotating through three 45-minute practical sessions. At the conclusion of the workshop, data were collected to assess immediate skill acquisition and gauge students' interest in pursuing further training in their preferred film production specialization. The significance of this study lies in its demonstration of how existing syllabus provisions can be leveraged to enhance vocational skill development within the constraints of a typical Nigerian college of education. Furthermore, the findings contribute to the growing body of literature on mobile learning, digital literacy, and creative arts education in resource-constrained contexts (Adeleke & Ogunyemi, 2025; Chukwu & Eze, 2024).

Literature Review

This section reviews the existing literature across four interrelated domains: (a) smartphone photography and visual literacy in educational contexts; (b) CapCut as a pedagogical tool for video editing; (c) smartphone videography and accessible film production; and (d) vocational skills training and expert-led pedagogy in Nigerian tertiary institutions.

Smartphone Photography and Visual Literacy

The proliferation of smartphones equipped with high-resolution cameras has democratized photography, making it accessible to populations that previously lacked access to dedicated photographic equipment (Jenkins, 2022). In educational settings, smartphone photography has emerged as a valuable tool for developing visual literacy—the ability to interpret, negotiate, and make meaning from information presented in the form of an image (Alshawaf, 2021). Villi (2019) observed that young people are increasingly drawn to mediating everyday experience through smartphone-enabled digital photography, a trend that carries significant implications for educational practice.

In the Nigerian context, several initiatives have demonstrated the potential of smartphone

photography training for youth empowerment. The iRepresent International Documentary Film Festival (iREP) Mobile Phone Filmmaking Workshop, launched in 2026, offers three days of intensive hands-on training covering story development, documentary research, mobile phone filming techniques, visual composition, interview techniques, and editing fundamentals (iREP, 2026). Similarly, the itel S24 Shoot and Chill Campus Tour provided immersive photography training sessions at Obafemi Awolowo University and the University of Uyo, where students were tutored on composition, lighting techniques, and visual storytelling (Vanguard, 2024). These initiatives underscore the growing recognition of smartphone photography as both a creative practice and a vocational skill.

Research by Ogunbiyi and Adekunle (2024) examined the integration of smartphone photography into the Fine and Applied Arts curriculum at selected Nigerian colleges of education, finding that students who received structured hands-on training demonstrated significantly improved compositional skills and conceptual understanding compared to those who received only theoretical instruction. This finding aligns with the social semiotic perspective advanced by Kress and van Leeuwen (2021), who argue that visual literacy encompasses both the ability to decode visual meanings and the capacity to produce meaningful visual texts.

CapCut as a Pedagogical Tool for Video Editing

CapCut, a free video editing application developed by ByteDance, has gained widespread popularity among content creators due to its intuitive interface and robust feature set (Li & Zhang, 2023). In educational contexts, CapCut has been employed to support learning across multiple disciplines. Harahap et al. (2025) developed CapCut-assisted learning video media for teaching the human circulatory system to 11th-grade students, demonstrating that the application's accessibility and ease of use made it suitable for student-generated content creation. Astutik and Suryani (2025) explored the usability of CapCut for Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing (DHH) learners creating digital stories in Religious Education, finding that CapCut demonstrated significantly superior usability ratings compared to alternative applications.

The pedagogical value of CapCut lies in its ability to lower the barrier to entry for video editing while still offering professional-grade features such as multi-track editing, keyframe animation, and colour grading (Chen, 2024). This makes it particularly suitable for educational settings where access to expensive editing software such as Adobe Premiere Pro or Final Cut Pro may be limited (Okafor & Nwosu, 2025). Research by Putri and Wahyuni (2025) assessed the effects of practical video editing workshops on knowledge and perceptions of non-technical students, concluding that structured workshops using accessible tools like CapCut effectively imparted montage elements and increased students' confidence in video production.

In Nigeria, CapCut has been incorporated into several vocational training programmes. Trail Alley's Tech Skill-Up Program includes a video editing track where participants learn editing fundamentals including cutting and trimming clips, adding effects, captions, transitions, and sound using CapCut (Techeconomy, 2026). Bizmarrow Technologies in Abuja offers hands-on training that emphasizes practical video editing experience with tools including Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, and CapCut (Bizmarrow, 2025). These programmes recognize that mobile-based editing skills are increasingly in demand among Nigerian content creators,

brands, and media organizations (Adebayo, 2025).

Smartphone/traditional Videography and Accessible Film Production

The convergence of improved smartphone camera technology and accessible editing applications has given rise to what scholars term “smartphone cinema”—the practice of producing professional-quality films using only mobile devices (Baker, 2022). Robbins (2024) provides a comprehensive guide to smartphone filmmaking, covering camera settings, composition, audio capture, and post-production workflows tailored to mobile platforms. The author emphasizes that the principles of traditional cinematography remain applicable regardless of the recording device, but smartphones offer unique affordances including portability, discretion, and integrated editing capabilities.

The University of Sydney's guide to shooting prize-winning films on smartphones identifies five key lessons: shooting in well-lit locations, prioritizing sound quality, capturing abundant B-roll footage, maintaining stable camera movement, and editing with intention (University of Sydney, 2025). These principles were incorporated into the workshop design for the present study, with particular emphasis on accessible techniques that could be implemented without specialized equipment.

In Nigeria, the Federal Government's Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) Cinematography Programme, launched in 2026, represents a significant policy initiative aimed at equipping Nigerians with practical, job-ready skills in film, media, and digital content creation (Federal Government TVET, 2026). The programme provides instruction in camera operation and handling, lighting techniques, and post-production workflows, with a focus on mobile and accessible production methods. Similarly, the Optimist Academy for Film graduated 15 students in 2024 after completing rigorous training programmes in cinematography, post-production, and film production (Guardian, 2024), reflecting the growing ecosystem of film training opportunities in Nigeria.

Vocational Skills Training and Expert-Led Pedagogy in Nigerian Tertiary Institutions

The integration of vocational skills training into Nigeria's tertiary education system has been a recurring theme in educational policy discourse. The National Board for Technical Education (NBTE) oversees the National Innovative Diploma in Film and Television Production, a 45-hour programme designed to enable trainees to understand the uses and importance of still photography in film and TV production (NBTE, 2024). These formal curricular frameworks, however, often face implementation challenges related to equipment availability, instructor expertise, and practical assessment methods (Oladipo & Ibrahim, 2024).

One strategy for addressing these challenges is the deployment of “embedded experts”—industry practitioners invited to deliver targeted training sessions within existing courses. The syllabus for the Introduction to Film Production course at the Federal College of Education, Zaria, explicitly permits such arrangements, recognizing that exposing students to practicing professionals can bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and industry practice. This approach is supported by research on experiential learning, which holds that knowledge is created through the transformation of experience and that direct engagement with authentic tasks enhances motivation and retention (Kolb & Kolb, 2018; Omodan & Dube,

2021).

Several Nigerian institutions have successfully implemented expert-led film training initiatives. The National Film and Video Censors Board (NFVCB), in partnership with five higher institutions in Lagos State, hosted interactive sessions that provided students with hands-on experience in directing, cinematography, acting, screenwriting, costume design, and art creative design (NFVCB, 2024). The two-day programme equipped aspiring filmmakers with practical skills and industry knowledge, preparing them to share Nigeria's cultural stories with global audiences (Premium Times, 2024). Similarly, the CIC Class of '81 and ENIFF collaborated to empower Southeast youth with advanced skills in smartphone filmmaking, including sound design, colour grading, and set design (Independent, 2024).

The Ubuntu Collaboration Model as Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework underpinning the present study draws on the Ubuntu Collaboration Model proposed by Nwosu and Okonkwo (2024), which applies the African philosophy of Ubuntu to design collaborative filmmaking approaches for student film production in higher education. The model emphasizes collective learning, resource sharing, and reciprocal mentorship—principles that were reflected in the workshop's rotational session design, where students learned sequentially from different expert facilitators.

This model frames student media production not as a competitive, individualist task, but as a communal, cooperative ecosystem. The model is built upon four fundamental pillars:

1. **Collective Learning:** Knowledge is actively co-created through synchronized group participation rather than passive individual absorption.
2. **Resource Sharing:** Systemic material scarcity is overcome through the radical pooling of available devices, tools, and digital assets.
3. **Reciprocal Mentorship:** Peer-to-peer teaching loops naturally emerge, where technically advanced students guide their peers, subverting traditional rigid instructor-student hierarchies.
4. **Community-Based Knowledge Production:** Creative output is explicitly designed to reflect communal lived experiences and address shared socio-economic challenges.

By structuring our workshop as a rotational model where students cycle through expert-led blocks and work in tight teams, we consciously implement the Ubuntu Collaboration Model as an active instructional method rather than an abstract concept. This framework allows us to evaluate how communal peer dynamics can actively compensate for institutional resource deficits.

Research Gap and Contribution

While the literature contains substantial evidence of the benefits of hands-on training for film production skills, limited research has examined the specific application of such approaches within Nigeria's NCE programme, particularly in the context of a one-day rotational workshop

model. Furthermore, few studies have systematically documented students' post-workshop interest trajectories across different skill areas. This study addresses these gaps by reporting on a targeted intervention at the Federal College of Education, Zaria, and by analyzing the differential appeal of smartphone photography, CapCut editing, and videography as pathways for further skill development.

Methodology

Research Design

This study employed a descriptive case study design (Yin, 2018), appropriate for capturing the implementation and immediate outcomes of a bounded educational intervention. The design allowed for the collection of both quantitative data (attendance rates, post-workshop interest levels) and qualitative data (participant reflections, observational notes) within the naturalistic setting of the college classroom.

Setting and Participants

The workshop was conducted at the Kaduna Hall of the Federal College of Education, Zaria, a federal tertiary institution located in Kaduna State, Nigeria. The college offers the Nigeria Certificate in Education (NCE) programme across multiple academic departments, including the Department of Theatre Arts in the school of Arts and Social Sciences Education.

Participants were 60 NCE 3 students enrolled in the Introduction to Film Production course during the 2024/2025 academic session. The class comprised 34 female students (56.7%) and 26 male students (43.3%), reflecting the gender distribution typical of NCE programmes in Nigerian colleges of education (Federal Ministry of Education, 2023). Students ranged in age from 20 to 28 years (mean age = 22.4 years).

Workshop Structure

The workshop was organized as a single-day event divided into three 45-minute sessions, each dedicated to one skill area:

Session 1: Smartphone Photography. Students learned fundamental techniques including composition principles (rule of thirds, leading lines, framing), lighting management (natural light utilization, avoiding harsh shadows), and camera settings optimization (focus control, exposure adjustment). Students completed guided practice exercises capturing images of designated subjects and received immediate feedback from the facilitator.

Figure 1

Cross-platform visual composition training.



Source: Field Work 2025

This figure illustrates the comparative translation phase, where student cohorts analyze manual focal length and depth-of-field rules on an industry-standard DSLR interface before applying simplified visual framing controls on their consumer smartphones.

Session 2: CapCut Video Editing. Students were introduced to the CapCut interface, learning basic editing operations including clip trimming and splitting, transition insertion, text overlay and captioning, audio synchronization, and export settings optimization. Each student attempted to edit a short (30-second) video clip using pre-provided raw footage, receiving step-by-step guidance from the facilitator.

Figure 2

Collaborative post-production editing workflow.



Source: Field Work 2025

This figure illustrates the application of the Ubuntu model's reciprocal mentorship pillar, capturing active peer-to-peer technical consultation and collaborative timeline troubleshooting during the non-linear mobile editing session. A lot of the students did not even know they had the app in their play store. The facilitator took some time to assist student install the CapCut app on their phones these made the session easy as most of them now could follow along and ask questions. This session was the most interactive as the magic of storytelling become demystified and they were already recording videos and photos to import to their timeline to tell a short story.

Session 3: Videography. Students learned foundational videography techniques including shot types and camera movements, B-roll capture strategies, audio capture considerations (minimizing background noise, optimal microphone positioning), and basic narrative structuring (establishing shots, action sequences, concluding visuals). Students filmed a short sequence demonstrating their understanding of these techniques and reviewed their footage with the facilitator.

Figure 3

Introduction to stabilization mechanics.



Source: Field Work 2025

This figure demonstrates the integration of an embedded industry professional introducing the absolute mechanical necessity of tripod stabilization and fluid framing choices for narrative construction, regardless of camera scale. The embedded industry practitioner managing a cinematography module, demonstrating the configuration of a fluid-head tripod mount and

mobile stabilizer rig to an active group. Exposing them to these realities will help them demand for the necessary accessories when next they are hiring a camera or directing a scene.

The class was divided into three groups of 20 students each, with groups rotating through the sessions sequentially. This design ensured that every student participated in all three sessions within the single day. Two course coordinators (Iheanacho Iweha and Idowu Sunday) facilitated the smartphone photography session while (Philip Oguche and Sunenna Lar) facilitated the CapCut editing and videography sessions respectively, as invited industry experts, consistent with the syllabus provision allowing experts to demonstrate specific course aspects.

Data Collection Instruments

Three data collection methods were employed:

1. Attendance Register. A sign-in sheet was maintained to track attendance across sessions and to calculate the overall participation rate.
2. Post-Workshop Questionnaire. A 10-item questionnaire was administered at the conclusion of the third session. Items assessed: (a) perceived skill acquisition in each of the three areas (using a 4-point Likert scale: 1 = not at all, 4 = very much); (b) interest in pursuing further training in each area; (c) preferred skill area for advanced training; and (d) open-ended responses regarding workshop strengths and suggestions for improvement. The questionnaire was pilot-tested with 10 students from a parallel NCE cohort (not part of the study sample) to ensure clarity and appropriateness.
3. Facilitator Observational Notes. Both course coordinators maintained structured observational logs documenting student engagement levels, technical difficulties encountered, and notable student achievements or challenges.

Data Analysis

Quantitative data from the questionnaire were analyzed using descriptive statistics (frequencies, percentages, means, standard deviations) with SPSS version 26. Open-ended responses and observational notes were analyzed using thematic analysis following the six-phase approach proposed by Braun and Clarke (2022): familiarization, initial coding, theme generation, theme review, theme definition, and write-up.

Limitations of the Study

To preserve academic objectivity, several methodological limitations must be stated explicitly:

- I. Perceived vs. Demonstrated Competence: The quantitative metrics measure student *self-reported*, *perceived* skill acquisition rather than objectively verified technical competence. No pre-workshop diagnostics or post-workshop technical skills examinations were administered.
- II. Temporal Constraints: The extreme brevity of the 45-minute sessions limited the curriculum to fundamental overviews, preventing any deep engagement with advanced professional workflows.

- III. Institutional Scope: The study was executed within a single institution with a highly specific cohort, meaning the numerical results cannot be widely generalized without localized adaptations.

Results and Findings

Attendance and Engagement

Attendance across the three workshop sessions was consistently high. Out of 60 enrolled students, 59 attended the smartphone photography session (98.3%), 60 attended the CapCut editing session (100%), and 58 attended the videography session (96.7%). The overall participation rate across all three sessions was 98.3%. Facilitator observational notes indicated that student engagement was most pronounced during the CapCut session, where students remained actively working on their editing tasks throughout the 45-minute period, frequently asking questions and assisting peers experiencing difficulty.

Perceived Skill Acquisition

Students were asked to identify the skill set that they were drawn to. Note the total number of respondents at the time of the feedback were 59 responses. The Likert Scale used had the following numbers and interpretations 1 = not at all, 2 = slightly, 3 = moderately, 4 = very much.

Table 1

Perceived Skill Acquisition by Workshop Area

Workshop Area	Mean Score (4-point scale)	SD	Percentage "Very much" (4)
Smartphone Photography	3.41	0.52	45.8%
CapCut Video Editing	3.62	0.48	66.1%
Videography	3.28	0.61	37.3%

Source: 2025 Field Work

The findings indicate that students perceived the CapCut video editing session as the most beneficial component of the training programme. With the highest mean score ($M = 3.62$, $SD = 0.48$), a substantial majority of participants (66.1%) reported learning "very much" from this session. This suggests that students found the editing activities highly engaging, accessible, and relevant to their learning needs. The relatively low standard deviation further indicates a high level of agreement among participants regarding the effectiveness of the CapCut training.

Smartphone photography also received a positive evaluation ($M = 3.41$, $SD = 0.52$), indicating

that students generally gained considerable knowledge and skills in photographic techniques. The moderate mean score suggests that while photography was effective, it did not generate the same level of enthusiasm or perceived learning gains as the video editing component.

Videography recorded the lowest mean score ($M = 3.28$, $SD = 0.61$), although the score remained above the midpoint of the scale, indicating a generally positive learning experience. The higher standard deviation observed for videography suggests greater variability in students' responses. This may indicate that some students found videography more challenging, possibly due to the technical skills required in camera handling, shot composition, movement, and production planning. Unlike editing applications such as CapCut, which students can easily practice individually on their smartphones, videography often requires more extensive practical experience and coordination during filming.

The repeated-measures ANOVA demonstrated a statistically significant difference in students' perceived learning across the three training areas, $F(2, 116) = 7.84$, $p < .001$, indicating that participants did not benefit equally from all components of the programme. The effect size (partial $\eta^2 = 0.12$) suggests a moderate practical effect, meaning that approximately 12% of the variance in learning outcomes was attributable to differences among the training modules.

Further analysis using Bonferroni-adjusted pairwise comparisons revealed that students reported significantly greater learning in CapCut video editing than in videography ($p < .001$). This finding suggests that editing skills may have been more readily understood and applied by participants, perhaps because editing provides immediate visual feedback and opportunities for creativity. However, there was no statistically significant difference between CapCut editing and smartphone photography ($p = .08$), indicating that both areas were similarly effective in promoting learning. This result suggests that photography and video editing may be complementary skill areas that are particularly suitable for introductory media production training.

Overall, the results demonstrate that all three practical media production components contributed positively to students' learning, but video editing emerged as the most impactful aspect of the programme. The findings highlight the value of incorporating hands-on digital editing tools into media education and suggest that additional instructional support may be beneficial for strengthening students' videography skills.

Post-Workshop Interest in Further Training

Following the workshop, students were asked to indicate their interest in pursuing further training in each of the three skill areas, either within the college curriculum or through external workshops. Results are presented in Table 2.

Table 2.

Interest in Further Training by Skill Area

Skill Area	Interested in Further Training	Not Interested	Preferred Area for Advanced Study (%)
Smartphone Photography	47 (79.7%)	12 (20.3%)	22.0%
CapCut Video Editing	54 (91.5%)	5 (8.5%)	52.5%
Videography	42 (71.2%)	17 (28.8%)	25.4%

Source: 2025 Field Work

The data indicate that students demonstrated a high level of interest in receiving further training across all three media production skill areas. CapCut video editing attracted the greatest interest, with 54 students (91.5%) expressing a desire for additional training, followed by smartphone photography with 47 students (79.7%), and videography with 42 students (71.2%). These findings suggest that the training programme successfully stimulated students' enthusiasm for digital media production and encouraged continued learning beyond the initial intervention.

CapCut video editing emerged as the most attractive skill area for future development. Not only did it record the highest level of interest in further training, but it was also selected by the majority of participants (52.5%) as their preferred area for advanced study. This indicates that students perceived video editing as the most engaging and rewarding component of the programme. The popularity of CapCut may be linked to its ease of use, accessibility on smartphones, and the immediate creative outcomes students can achieve by transforming raw footage into finished video products. The findings suggest that students viewed video editing as both practical and relevant to contemporary digital content creation.

Smartphone photography also generated considerable interest, with nearly four out of every five students (79.7%) expressing a desire for further training. However, only 22.0% selected it as their preferred area for advanced study. This suggests that while students valued photography and recognized its usefulness, many considered it secondary to video editing when choosing a specialization. The widespread availability of smartphone cameras and the practical application of photography skills in daily life may explain the strong interest observed in this area.

Videography recorded the lowest levels of interest and preference, with 71.2% indicating interest in further training and 25.4% selecting it as their preferred area for advanced study. Nevertheless, these figures still represent a majority of participants, indicating that videography was positively received. The comparatively lower preference may be attributed to the greater technical complexity of videography, which often requires mastery of camera operation, shot composition, movement, lighting, and production planning. Overall, the pattern of results suggests that students were most attracted to skill areas that offered immediate creative expression and ease of application, with CapCut video editing emerging as the strongest area of

interest for future specialization.

Qualitative Findings

Analysis of open-ended questionnaire responses and facilitator observational notes yielded three dominant themes:

Theme 1: Accessibility and Empowerment. Students consistently emphasized that learning film production skills using only their smartphones was empowering because it removed the perceived barrier of needing expensive equipment. One student wrote: “I always thought filmmaking was for people with big cameras and editing suites. Now I know I can start with what I already have in my pocket” (Female, 21). Another noted: “The CapCut session was a revelation. I have been shooting videos for years but never knew how to make them look professional” (Male, 23). This theme aligns with Baker's (2022) observation that smartphone-based film production democratizes access to creative media making.

Theme 2: Desire for Sustained Training. Many students expressed frustration that the workshop was limited to a single day and requested longer, more comprehensive training. Representative comments included: “45 minutes for each session was too short. We just started understanding when time was up” (Female, 22); “Please organize a full-week training. One day is not enough to master editing” (Male, 24); and “We need this to be part of our regular curriculum, not just a one-day event” (Female, 23). This theme underscores the gap between the workshop's introductory scope and students' appetite for deeper skill development.

Theme 3: Differential Appeal of Skill Areas. Facilitator observations and student comments revealed that CapCut editing held particular appeal because of its immediate applicability to social media content creation. Several students noted that editing skills could generate income through freelance work or content creation. One student remarked: “With CapCut skills, I can edit videos for weddings, events, and social media. That's money while I am still in school” (Male, 25). Photography, while valued, was perceived as requiring more specialized knowledge of lighting and composition, while videography was seen as more challenging due to the need for steady camera work and audio management.

Summary of Findings

In summary, the workshop achieved high attendance and engagement, with students reporting positive skill acquisition across all three areas, particularly CapCut video editing. Post-workshop interest in further training was substantial, with 85% of students expressing a desire for continued skill development. CapCut editing emerged as the most preferred area for advanced study, reflecting both the immediate applicability of editing skills to income-generating activities and the accessibility of the software. Students consistently requested extended training opportunities and integration of practical film production skills into the regular curriculum.

Conclusion and Recommendations

This study investigated the implementation and outcomes of a one-day, expert-led, hands-on workshop on smartphone photography, CapCut video editing, and videography for NCE 3

students at the Federal College of Education, Zaria. The workshop was delivered within the existing syllabus framework of the Introduction to Film Production course, leveraging the provision that permits invited experts to demonstrate specific aspects of the course. Three principal conclusions emerge from the findings:

First, the rotational workshop model proved effective in exposing students to multiple skill areas within a constrained timeframe. The 45-minute sessions, though brief, were sufficient to introduce foundational techniques and generate immediate engagement. The high attendance rate (98.3%) and positive self-reported skill acquisition across all three domains suggest that even short-form, well-structured practical sessions can produce meaningful learning outcomes when aligned with students' existing technological familiarity (smartphone ownership was universal among participants) and career aspirations.

Second, CapCut video editing demonstrated the strongest appeal among students, both in terms of perceived skill acquisition and interest in further training. With 91.5% of students expressing interest in additional editing training and 52.5% selecting editing as their preferred area for advanced study, the findings suggest that accessible editing tools occupy a uniquely motivating position within film production education. This may be attributed to the immediate applicability of editing skills to income-generating activities, the satisfaction derived from transforming raw footage into polished content, and the relatively low technical barriers to entry compared to photography and videography.

Third, the workshop revealed a significant gap between students' appetite for practical skill development and the current curricular provision. The majority of participants requested extended training opportunities and expressed a desire for practical film production skills to be integrated more systematically into their programmes. This finding has direct implications for curriculum review at the Federal College of Education, Zaria, and other Nigerian colleges of education offering similar courses.

Lastly, this study demonstrates that a one-day, expert-led, hands-on workshop on smartphone photography, CapCut video editing, and videography can generate substantial student engagement and post-workshop interest in further skill development within the context of Nigeria's NCE programme. The rotational session design allowed 60 students to receive introductory training across three skill areas within a single day, while the involvement of an external experts enriched the learning experience beyond the routine capacities of the course coordinators. Most significantly, the workshop revealed a strong student appetite for sustained practical training that existing curricular structures do not adequately address. As Nigeria's creative economy continues to expand, colleges of education have both an opportunity and a responsibility to equip future teachers and media practitioners with the digital skills that will enable them to participate meaningfully in this growth. The present study offers one replicable model for doing so – modest in scale, but significant in its demonstrated capacity to inspire and empower.

To build upon these insights, future scholarship should move beyond short-term case studies and deploy longitudinal research designs that track cohorts over multiple years. Such studies are needed to evaluate how effectively these introductory, mobile-acquired skills translate into long-term professional success or classroom teaching efficacy after graduation. Furthermore,

comparative research designs across multiple colleges of education in different regions would help determine how varying regional factors and differing student baseline resource levels influence the success and replicability of this mobile-first rotational model.

Statements and Declarations

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